

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: The central development question and the five-rung ladder

CENTRAL QUESTION -> what counts as a better society, and how do
material changes become morally justified progress?

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FIVE RUNGS (each adds a question the previous rung cannot answer)

growth	-> more output / income	measure: quantity
development	-> structural and qualitative change	measure: opportunity
human dev.	-> health, knowledge, material command	measure: human options
capability	-> substantive freedom to be and do	measure: real opportunity
social prog.	-> justified social relations/institutions measure: freedom, equality, justice, dignity, participation, sustainability	

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ECONOMISTIC MODEL -> productivity / investment / industrialisation -> resources
enabling truth: scarcity blocks health, education and choice
failure: output says nothing by itself about distribution, voice, work
quality, displacement or ecological cost

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MASTER VERDICT -> growth can finance development; just conversion into
capability, dignity, participation and sustainable institutions makes progress.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: Human development and Sen's resource-to-freedom conversion

HAQ / UNDP -> shift from wealth of economy to lives of people:

longevity + knowledge + decent material standard

| limitation: composite indices can conceal distribution, freedom,
| gender, disability and ecological dependence

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SEN -> DEVELOPMENT AS FREEDOM; remove unfreedoms, expand substantive freedom

RESOURCE -> personal / social / environmental CONVERSION FACTORS -> CAPABILITY

same income -> disability, gender norms, location, public services -> unequal freedom

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+> FUNCTIONING = achieved being/doing

+> CAPABILITY = real opportunity for alternative functionings

+> UTILITY = satisfaction; may adapt downward under deprivation

+> AGENCY = pursue goals one has reason to value beyond welfare

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FIVE FREEDOMS REINFORCE: political freedom | economic facilities | social
opportunities | transparency guarantees | protective security

CONTROL -> capability is neither income plus schemes nor compulsory functioning.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Nussbaum, dependency, post-development and sustainability

SEN vs NUSSBAUM

Sen -> public reasoning; no single final canonical list

Nussbaum -> central capabilities; dignity-compatible threshold

common -> secure OPPORTUNITY, not compulsory FUNCTIONING

tension -> plural openness vs paternalistic closure / underspecification

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DEPENDENCY -> underdevelopment can be PRODUCED through unequal incorporation,
not merely inherited as an earlier stage on one universal path

POST-DEVELOPMENT -> who authorises experts to define a whole society as deficient?

trap -> neither critique proves that health, education, mobility or infrastructure
are unwanted; local voice joins universal dignity and non-domination

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SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT -> present improvement without destroying ecological
conditions/options for future persons: intergenerational justice + precaution +
non-substitutable limits + duties to vulnerable persons + possible non-human value.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Social progress: weak teleology, plural criteria and non-inevitability

SOCIAL PROGRESS = justified improvement in relations, institutions and lives

weakly TELEOLOGICAL -> calls movement better; does NOT posit automatic history

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CRITERIA (no one aggregate settles all)

freedom: real options/voice | equality: less domination | justice: defensible

benefits/burdens/procedure | dignity: no humiliation | participation: co-decision

sustainability: future conditions | fraternity/solidarity: social equality

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WHY NOT INEVITABLE?

knowledge/technology -> capacity for care AND destruction

institutions -> distribute control and risk

moral learning -> can be reversed

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VERDICT -> progress requires agency, conflict, accountable institutions and judgment;

public reasoning is part of progress, not merely a way to measure it.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: Necessary, sufficient, redistribution, recognition and democracy

2024 MODAL TEST -> Is economic development necessary, sufficient, both or neither?

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NECESSITY -> severe deprivation blocks health, education, agency

qualified result -> adequate MATERIAL CAPABILITIES normally threshold-necessary

caveat -> 'economic development' is broader than a logical necessity claim

SUFFICIENCY -> wealth can coexist with exclusion, authoritarianism, gender

hierarchy and ecological destruction -> clearly NOT sufficient

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DISTRIBUTION + RECOGNITION + PARTICIPATION

redistribution -> resources; recognition -> equal status; participation -> decision-power

provision without respect -> paternalism | recognition without resources -> symbolism

participation is INSTRUMENTAL (information/accountability) AND CONSTITUTIVE (voice itself)

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VERDICT -> means become progress only through just conversion and democratic equality.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Technology and skill education: conditional routes to development

TECHNOLOGY -> changes capacities and social relations; supplies NO ethical end
possible gains -> medicine reduces suffering | communication widens knowledge |
transparency supports accountability | productivity reduces drudgery
possible losses -> surveillance/manipulation | unequal access | automation/displacement | bias
conversion conditions -> ethical purpose + fair access + accountable human control
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SKILL EDUCATION -> relevant competence -> work options -> productivity + bargaining power +
self-respect -> capability and agency
must add -> decent work | equal access | adaptability | dignity of labour | critical citizenship
defeat -> skills without decent work = frustrated capability; narrow employability can displace
civic/humanistic education; rapid technical change can make training obsolete
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VERDICT -> technology/skill enhance development conditionally, never automatically.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Gandhian social development and the Ambedkarite safeguard

GANDHIAN END -> SARVODAYA: welfare and moral elevation of all

SWARAJ: moral/economic self-rule; AHIMSA: non-violent means

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UNLIMITED WANTS -> dependence + competition + violence

CENTRALISED INDUSTRIAL POWER -> distance from need/local control; degraded labour

MEANS SHAPE ENDS -> violent/degrading means cannot yield a non-violent good society

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DEVELOPMENT -> decentralisation | village-centred production | dignity of labour |
trusteeship | restraint of wants | participation | ecological restraint

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OBJECTIONS -> village can reproduce caste/patriarchy; trusteeship is voluntary paternalism;
complex needs may require large-scale technique

RECONSTRUCTION -> equal rights + anti-domination + mobility + accountability; judge machines
by scale/control/need, not by a blanket anti-machine rule.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Tribal reconciliation: the four tests and legal-status discipline

THE COLLISION -> who defines benefit? who bears cost/risk? is land commodity or identity/livelihood? whose knowledge counts? are consent and self-government real?

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FOUR JOINT TESTS

1 capability -> count capabilities GAINED AND DESTROYED

2 agency -> affected communities decide, not merely receive compensation

3 precaution -> irreversible ecological/cultural loss attracts presumption against

4 justice -> no transfer of adjustment burden to persons least able to bear it

plus -> equal citizenship + recognition + individual/community rights

+ dissent/exit + gender justice

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INDIAN ILLUSTRATIONS, EXACT STATUS

PESA 1996 -> enacted statute, adapted panchayat arrangements in Scheduled Areas

FRA 2006 -> enacted rights-recognition statute

Orissa Mining Corporation (2013) -> Supreme Court judgment; Gram Sabha consideration

CONTROL -> enactment/judgment is NOT notification, implementation, success or philosophical proof.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: Moral standing and Naess: ecology before environmental policy

PRIOR QUESTION -> what has MORAL STANDING?

anthropocentric -> human beings; nature has instrumental value

weakness: ignores unseen or unusable nature

biocentric -> individual living beings with inherent worth; weakness: cannot easily value systems

ecocentric -> species/habitats/ecosystems/biotic whole; weakness: can subordinate individuals

discriminating question -> destroy wilderness no human will see/use/know?

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NAESS (1973): SHALLOW vs DEEP ECOLOGY

shallow -> fight pollution/depletion for human health/affluence; manage symptoms

deep -> intrinsic non-human value + diversity + revise framework of standing reserve

argument -> ever-rising consumption absorbs efficiency gains; policy fixes symptoms while the
generating conception of self/good life remains

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QUALIFICATION -> distinguish subsistence from luxury consumption; defend dignity/agency against
eco-authoritarian sacrifice and do not assert intrinsic value without argument.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Productivism, degrowth and intergenerational justice

PRODUCTIVISM -> expanding production is master objective and solvent of distributional conflict
applies to industrial socialism AS WELL AS capitalism

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FINITE SINKS/STOCKS + efficiency offset by output expansion + diminishing capability gains

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DEGROWTH -> planned reduction of energy/material throughput
sufficiency + care + shorter work + equality

objection -> jobs, revenue, public services; no demonstrated stable contraction at scale

qualified reply -> CONTRACTION AND CONVERGENCE: reduce affluent luxury; expand base capability
where deprivation persists; never prescribe blanket degrowth

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INTERGENERATIONAL JUSTICE -> preserve options, avoid irreversible loss

problems -> non-identity | no reciprocity | pure time preference/discounting

response -> impersonal principles + precaution, not specific future preferences

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: Environmentalism of the poor and the just-transition reply

ENVIRONMENTALISM OF THE POOR (Guha and Martinez-Alier, 1997)

claim -> Global South environmental conflict often concerns livelihood: forests, water, grazing, fisheries, clean air and control of resources on which subsistence depends

reframing -> NOT 'environment versus development' but WHO gains, WHO bears cost/risk, WHO decides

control -> thesis describes conflict structure, NOT ecological virtue of every poor community

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ECO-AUTHORITARIAN CLAIM -> limits are urgent; democracy is slow; insulate decisions

reply 1 epistemic -> dispersed local knowledge

reply 2 compliance -> imposed policies are evaded/reversed and costly to enforce

reply 3 accountability -> dissent/information reveal damage

reply 4 distributive -> no durable policy shifts cost onto vulnerable workers/communities

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JUST TRANSITION -> livelihood + retraining + compensation + participation BEFORE restructuring.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: The directive decoder and complete development answer spine

READ THE DIRECTIVE FIRST

explain -> conception/components/distinction/example

discuss -> conception/rival/objection/reply/verdict

evaluate -> standard/application/counter-case/judgment

necessary/sufficient -> test EACH separately, then modal verdict

agree -> qualified commitment first; reconcile -> collision plus conditions;

causal -> mechanism plus defeater

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UNIVERSAL SPINE

1 conception under dispute -> 2 provisional thesis -> 3 mechanism/conversion conditions ->

4 named evidence or correctly classified Indian illustration -> 5 strongest objection ->

6 reply + residual limit -> 7 distribution: benefit/cost/decision -> 8 graded verdict

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FINAL CONTROL -> means != conversion conditions != final values; statute/judgment/constitutional
commitment establish legal status, never implementation, empirical effect
or philosophical correctness.